Exercise 2

Setting up a Zoho Creator Account and Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

Submitted by

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Roll No: 241401056

Architecture Diagram

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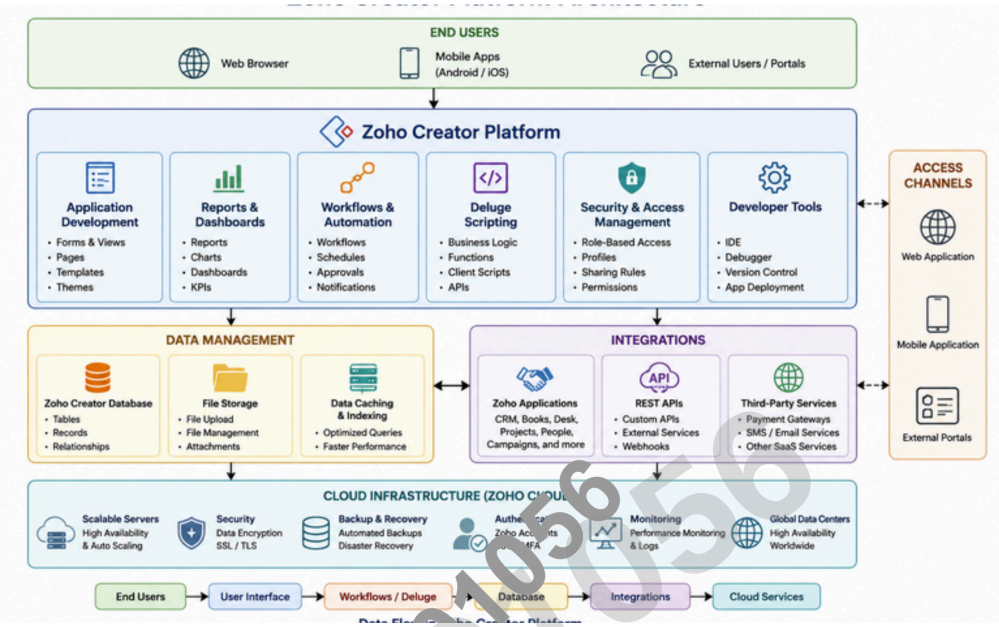


Figure 1: Zoho Creator platform architecture

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- **End Users:** Users access the application through a web browser, mobile app, or external portal to perform tasks and manage data.
- **Zoho Creator Platform:** The core platform where applications are developed using forms, pages, reports, dashboards, workflows, and Deluge scripting. It also provides role-based security to control user access.
- **Data Management:** All application data, records, and uploaded files are stored in the Zoho Creator database, ensuring organized and secure data management.
- **Integrations:** Zoho Creator connects with Zoho applications (CRM, Books, Desk, etc.), REST APIs, and third-party services such as email, SMS, and payment gateways to exchange data seamlessly.
- **Cloud Infrastructure:** The platform runs on Zoho Cloud, which provides secure hosting, authentication, automatic backups, scalability, monitoring, and high availability.
- **Data Flow:** End Users → Zoho Creator Platform → Database → Integrations → Cloud Infrastructure

Dashboard

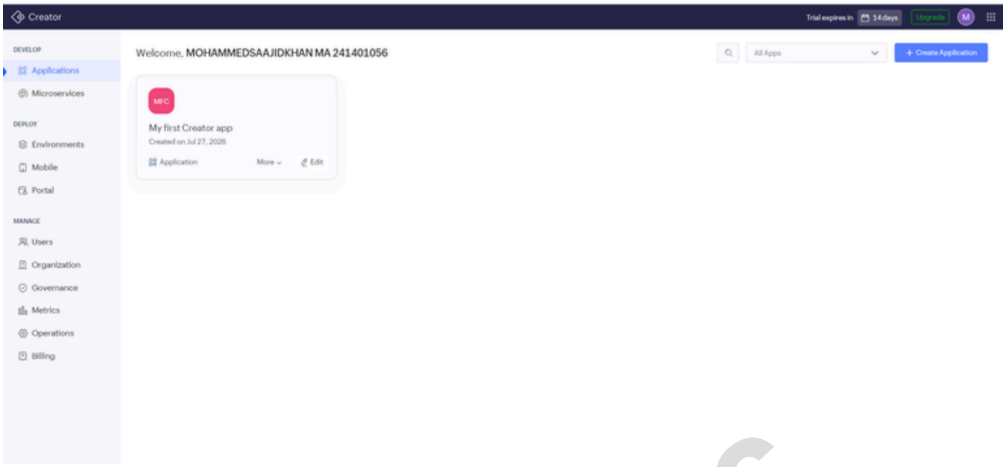


Figure 2: Zoho Creator dashboard - home screen

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- The Dashboard is the home page of Zoho Creator.
- It is the first screen users see after logging in.
- It provides access to all applications in one place.
- Users can create a new application or open an existing one.
- The dashboard displays recently used applications for quick access.
- It allows users to manage forms, reports, pages, and workflows.
- Users can organize applications into folders for better management.
- Search options help users find applications quickly.
- The dashboard also provides access to account settings and user profile.
- It acts as the central control panel for developing and managing applications.
- Its simple and user-friendly interface makes navigation easy for both beginners and experienced users.
- The dashboard helps developers save time by providing all essential tools in one location.

Create New Application

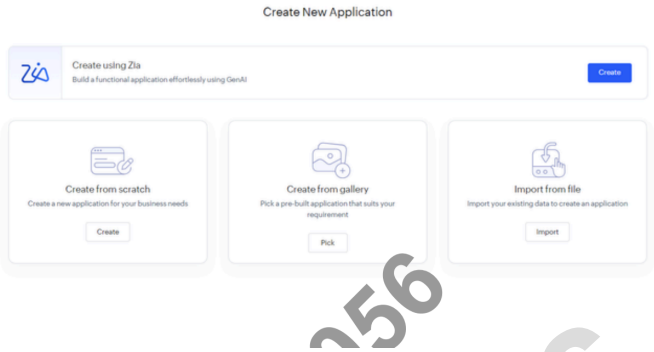


Figure 3: Create New Application dialog

This page is used to create a new application in Zoho Creator. It provides different options based on the user's requirements.

- **Create using Zia:** Uses Zoho's AI assistant (Zia) to build an application automatically from your requirements, making development faster.
- **Create from Scratch:** Allows users to build a completely new application by designing forms, reports, and workflows from the beginning.
- **Create from Gallery:** Lets users choose from a collection of ready-made templates that can be customized to meet their business needs.
- **Import from File:** Enables users to create an application by importing existing data from files such as Excel or CSV.

Benefits

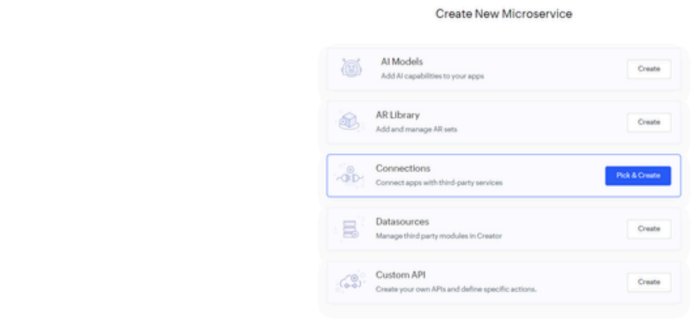
- Offers multiple ways to start building an application.
- Saves development time with AI and templates.
- Supports importing existing business data.
- Suitable for both beginners and experienced developers.

Summary

The Create New Application page provides flexible options to start developing an application. Users can use AI, build from scratch, choose a template, or import existing data, making application development quick and simple.

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Create New Microservice



is page is used to create Microservices in Zoho Creator. Microservices are additional fe

Figure 4: Create New Microservice dialog

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This page is used to create Microservices in Zoho Creator. Microservices are additional features that extend your application's capabilities, such as AI, integrations, APIs, and external data connections.

The Create New Microservice page allows users to add advanced features to their applications by selecting different services.

1. AI Models

- Adds Artificial Intelligence (AI) features to the application.
- Can be used for predictions, text analysis, and smart automation.
- Helps make applications more intelligent and efficient.

2. AR Library

- Used to add and manage Augmented Reality (AR) assets.
- Allows users to create interactive AR experiences within applications.
- Useful for product visualization, education, and training applications.

3. Connections

- Connects the application with third-party services.
- Supports integrations with platforms such as Google, Microsoft, and payment gateways.
- Enables secure data sharing between different applications.

4. Datasources

- Connects Zoho Creator with external databases or third-party modules.
- Allows applications to access and manage data from different sources.
- Eliminates the need to store duplicate data.

5. Custom API

- Allows developers to create their own APIs.
- Helps applications communicate with external systems.
- Enables secure data exchange and custom integrations.

Benefits

- Adds advanced features to applications.
- Supports AI, APIs, and third-party integrations.
- Makes applications more powerful and scalable.
- Improves automation and data sharing.

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Environments (Deployment)

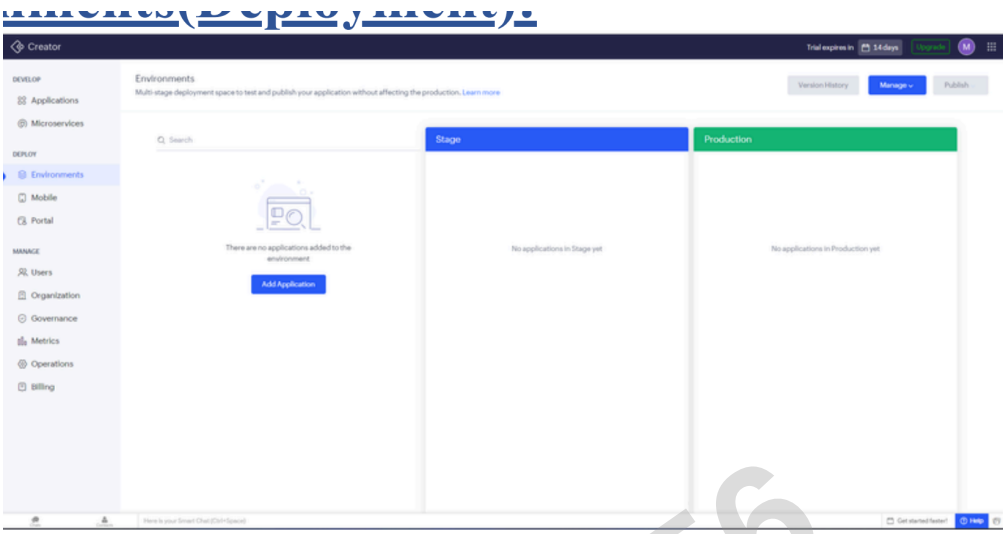


Figure 5: Environments - Stage and Production

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1. Development

- This is where applications are created and modified.
- Developers build new features and fix issues before testing.

2. Stage

- The Stage environment is used to test the application.
- Developers can check if all features work correctly before publishing.
- It helps identify and fix errors without affecting live users.

3. Production

- The Production environment contains the final version of the application.
- This is the version that end users access.
- Only tested and approved applications are deployed here.

Other Features

- **Add Application:** Adds an application to the selected environment.
- **Version History:** Displays previous versions of the application and allows developers to track changes.
- **Manage:** Provides options to configure and organize environments.
- **Publish:** Deploys the tested application from Stage to Production.

Benefits

- Separates development, testing, and live deployment.
- Reduces errors before releasing the application.

- Makes application updates safer and more organized.
- Helps maintain different versions of the application.

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Create Portal (Deployment)

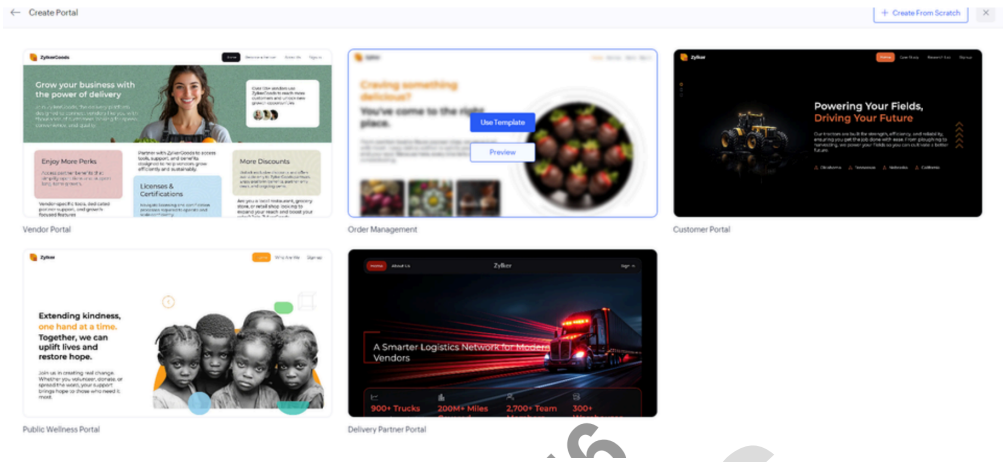


Figure 6: Portal templates - Vendor, Customer, and Delivery Partner portals

The Create Portal page is used to create a secure portal where external users, such as customers, vendors, or partners, can access the application without having a Zoho Creator account.

Features

- Creates a secure login portal for external users.
- Allows customers, vendors, or partners to access the application.
- Users can register and log in using their own credentials.
- Administrators can control who can view or edit data.
- Different user roles and permissions can be assigned.
- The portal can be customized with a company logo, colors, and branding.
- Provides secure access to forms, reports, and dashboards.
- Helps businesses share applications with users outside the organization.

Benefits

- Secure access for external users.
- Easy user management with role-based permissions.
- Customizable portal appearance.
- Improves collaboration with customers and partners.

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Users and Governance (Manage)

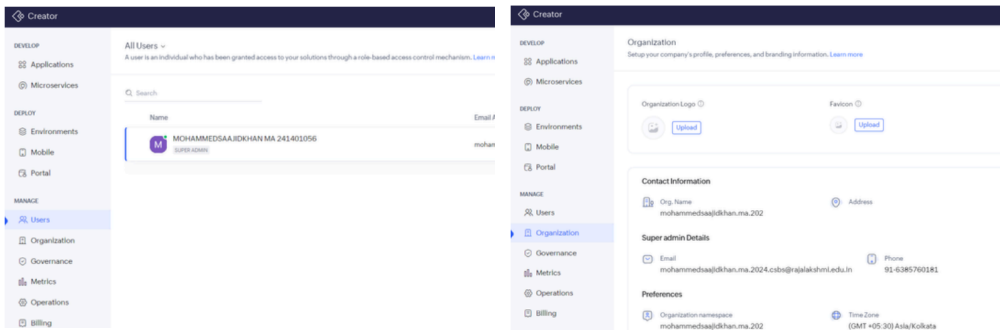


Figure 7: Users and Organization settings screens

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Users

- Add and manage users who can access the application.
- Assign roles such as Admin, Developer, or User.
- Control permissions to view, edit, create, or delete records.
- Remove or deactivate users when access is no longer required.
- Manage user groups for easier administration.

Governance

- Configure security and access policies.
- Monitor application activities and user actions.
- Protect business data through access controls.
- Ensure compliance with organizational standards.
- Manage approval policies and application security.

Benefits

- Provides secure access to applications.
- Protects sensitive business data.
- Simplifies user and permission management.
- Helps maintain compliance and security standards.
- Improves overall application administration.

Metrics and Operations (Manage)

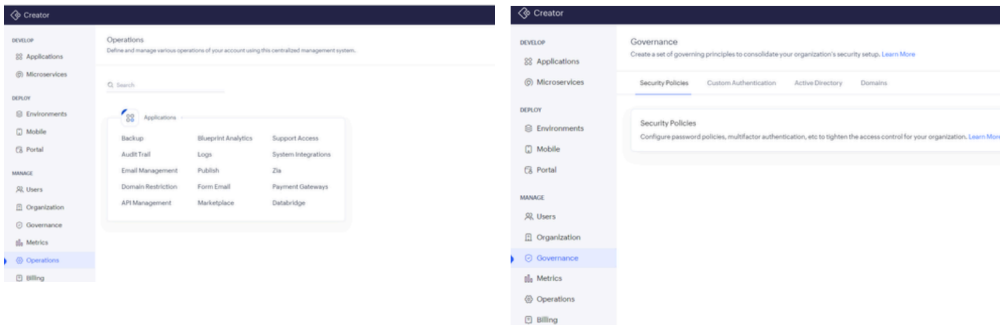


Figure 8: Operations and Governance screens

Metrics

The Metrics page displays reports and statistics about the application's performance and usage.

Features

- Monitors application usage and active users.
- Tracks records created, updated, and deleted.
- Displays charts and reports for data analysis.
- Helps identify performance trends and application health.

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Operations

The Operations page provides tools to maintain and manage the application.

Features

- Monitors application status and system activities.
- Displays logs for troubleshooting.
- Supports data import, export, backup, and recovery.
- Helps manage updates and application maintenance.

Benefits

- Monitors application performance and user activity.
- Improves system reliability and efficiency.
- Simplifies maintenance and troubleshooting.
- Protects data through backup and recovery.

Billing (Manage)

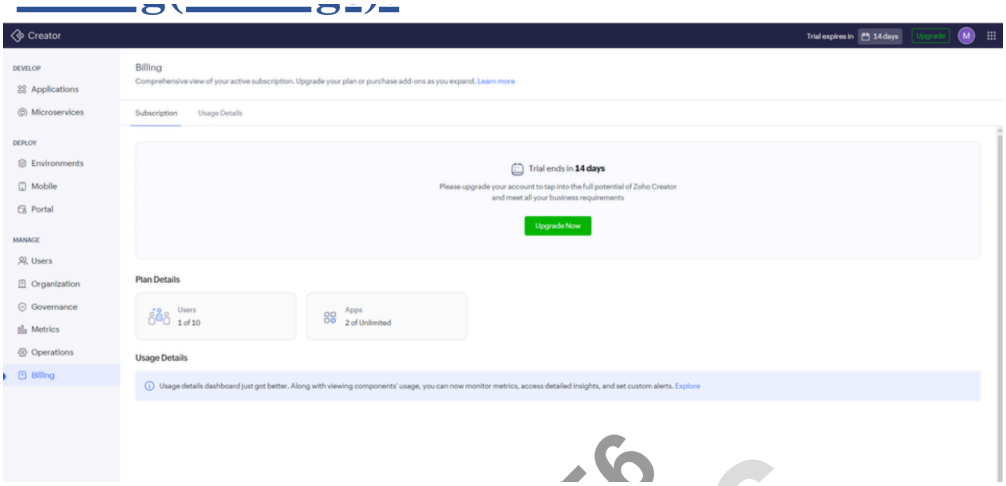


Figure 9: Billing and subscription overview

The Billing section in Zoho Creator helps administrators manage the organization's subscription, payments, and account usage. It provides information about the current plan, billing details, and resource consumption.

Features

- View the current subscription plan and pricing.
- Manage payment methods and billing information.
- Download invoices and payment receipts.
- Track application usage and available resources.
- Upgrade or downgrade the subscription plan.
- Monitor license and user limits.

Benefits

- Keeps billing information organized.
- Helps monitor subscription and resource usage.
- Simplifies payment and invoice management.
- Makes it easy to upgrade plans as business needs grow.

Summary

The Billing section allows administrators to manage subscription plans, payments, invoices, and account usage. It helps organizations track costs, monitor resource consumption, and ensure uninterrupted access to Zoho Creator services.

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